



Robert 'RazerGuy' Krakoff dead

Co-founder and former president of hardware giants, Razer, Robert Krakoff has died at the age of 81. <https://digit.in/may22-50>



401(k) as Bitcoins

Fidelity announces plan for saving portion of 401(k) as Bitcoin for eligible individuals. <https://digit.in/may22-51>

Nokia G21

Back in the game?

The Nokia G21 is the latest budget phone from the house of HMD Global with features like the 50MP triple-camera setup, a 5050mAh battery and a functional design. We tested the Nokia G21 for more than a week, judging its performance and seeing how it handles day-to-day tasks. Let's take a look.

DESIGN AND DISPLAY

Credit where credit's due, the Nokia G21 is really well built. Though it is still made of plastic, it has a patterned design on the back that provides some grip. It has a thickness of 8.5 millimetres and weighs 190 grams, which is thinner and lighter than the G20. Unlike the G20, the G21 does not come with splash protection.

You get the power button on the right side which doubles up as a fingerprint reader. On the left side, there is a SIM tray and a dedicated Google Assistant button. On top is a 3.5mm headphone jack and right at the bottom, we get a Type-C port and a speaker.

The display on the G21 measures 6.5 inches but only offers an HD+ resolution which is a bummer for a phone in this price range. The addition of a 90Hz refresh rate is welcome and makes user interactions all the more smooth.

The display offers decent brightness levels and in our testing, the peak brightness touched 359 nits while the minimum brightness was at 4 nits. However, the sunlight legibility goes for a toss when you take it outdoors.

PERFORMANCE

The Nokia G21 is powered by the Unisoc T606 chipset that has an octa-core CPU with two Cortex-A75 cores running at upto 1.6GHz and six Cortex-A55 cores also running at upto 1.6GHz. It runs on stock Android 11 and is ready for the Android 12 update but we'd have loved it if it launched with Android 12 out-of-the-box. Nokia



promises 2 years of OS upgrades and 3 years of security updates.

The general day to day performance of the Nokia G21 is decent as it does the basics right. In our use, we didn't notice major lags or frame drops and the 90Hz refresh rate display comes in handy to ensure the phone feels smooth to use.

Taking a look at the synthetic benchmark performance of the Nokia G21, it received a decent score on the AnTuTu test but isn't able to match the performance offered by the Realme 9i. Similarly, it gets better scores than the G20 in Geekbench single-core and multi-core tests but lags behind its Snapdragon counterpart. In the CPU throttling test, the Nokia G21 throttled to 92 percent of its maximum performance. We tried playing some games on the Nokia G21 as well. As you'd have imagined by now, the Nokia G21 is not a phone to play intensive games like Battlegrounds Mobile India and even Asphalt 9. However, it is way better at handling these games than the G20.

CAMERA

There are three cameras on the back of the G21 including a 50MP primary camera with an f/1.8 aperture, a 2MP macro camera and a 2MP depth sensor.

The camera stack from the G20 was one of its major highlights and the G21 follows suit by upgrading the main sensor. That said, the G21 does not get an ultra-wide camera like its predecessor. In daylight, the cameras of the G21 make some good looking images. The pictures look bright and colourful with natural tones. It is able to capture granular details like shadows and keeps the highlights in check. The other two cameras are just there to make up the numbers and fail to produce good pictures.

BATTERY LIFE

The Nokia G21 is equipped with the same 5,050mAh battery as the G20 from last year. However, it still does not support fast charging and comes with a 10W charging adapter in the box. This means that it takes forever to fully charge but the battery life is good enough for most users. Some browsing, casual gaming, watching videos on YouTube and checking out social feeds, the Nokia G21 easily gave us two days worth of battery life on a single charge.

VERDICT

The Nokia G21 builds upon some of the limitations of the G20 for us to be able to recommend it. However, only if you're looking for a pretty basic, no-nonsense smartphone. Nokia has brought about solid upgrades to the G21 but it does little to impact the dominance of competing brands like Xiaomi and Realme in the budget segment.

—Siddharth Chauhan

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 6.5-inch LCD, HD+ (1600x720 pixels), 90Hz refresh rate | WEIGHT: 190g | PROCESSOR: Unisoc T606 | RAM: 4GB/6GB | BUILT-IN STORAGE: 64GB/128GB | EXPANDABLE STORAGE: Yes, upto 512GB microSD card | OS: Android 11 | REAR CAMERA: 50MP + 2MP macro + 2MP depth | REAR CAMERA VIDEO: 1080p (30FPS) | FRONT CAMERA: 8MP | BATTERY AND CHARGING: 5,050mAh, 18W fast charging (10W charger in the box)

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